

<< REWIND

STATE MATTERS

The States Reorganisation Act of 1956 remains the single most extensive change in state boundaries since the Independence of India in 1947. It took 9,000 interviews, visits to 104 places and 1,52,250 memorandums before the Act, creating 14 states and six Union territories, was passed. The Act led to the formation of Kerala and Bombay. A new article was also added to the Constitution that ensured linguistic minorities the right of education in their mother tongue.

"WITH GRACE AND GOODWILL."



Photo by Three Lions/Getty Images



The formal end of French rule was marked by a treaty signed in Delhi. Pondicherry, Karikal, Mahe and Yanam were declared Indian territories. Jawaharlal Nehru praised the French for their "tolerance, good sense and wisdom"

FIRST CUT

- Sulochana Modi became the first female mayor of Bombay.
- The mile-and-a-half-long Banihal tunnel, an all-weather link in Kashmir, was inaugurated.

- The first steel tube plant at Jamshedpur went into operation.
- Lambretta, the first scooter, was introduced.
- India reached the semi-finals of the Olympic football tournament.

<< DID YOU KNOW

India celebrated the 2,500th Buddha Jayanti with celebrations organised all over the country. This included an international exhibition of Buddhist art.